

Toshiba's new Strata

Toshiba's Strata Messaging services is an affordable unified messaging service for SMBs and SoHos

3X deploys cloud

3X systems has launched private cloud storage solutions for SMBs to save their documents in a private central location

Where is this SoHo headed?

The first couple of years showed them the trouble that most creative agencies go through, which is the lack of a portfolio. Their big break came a year into the venture when a big international studio handed them a project. Since then, they've worked with studios like Vivendi, Foundation 9 and Sierra.

Pixeltek has found that some of the really big companies will only outsource work to a studio if it has more than 25 people, due to the scale of their projects. To reach this level, Vitek plans on doubling the staff over the next two years.

Contentmixi.com

Sundeep Tibrewal and Abhishek Rungta run a SoHo that caters specifically to other SoHos. They call it Contentmixi.com, simply because it offers customers both textual and graphical content.

What's this SoHo about?

SoHos have design and content needs like any organisation. At some point every company looks for a logo or a web site template designer. This is the space that Contentmixi.com targets. For example, if your company is looking for a logo design and doesn't want the hassle of rummaging through the designers in your city, then log on to the site and choose the kind of logo you want. Pay for it and Contentmixi.com passes on the payments to the vendors.

How does this SoHo run?

The company is now a couple of months old, has a team of seven and works out of two small offices in Kolkata. Sundeep and three of his team members sit in a small 100 square foot room in the heart of the city.

The particular office space is equipped with three desktops and a laptop. His other partner sits about five kilometres with the other two team members. Each of the employees take care of a particular product. Right now, products are logos, web site



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templates, articles, e-books, illustrations and animations. Vendors for each of these products upload their wares to the site and name their price. When an aspiring SoHo chooses to buy a certain product, like an e-book or a logo design, they pay for it and Contentmixi gets their cut.



The team at Contentmixi is young

How does technology help further their business?

The company uses open source software to save on the licensing fees of the various office applications across the seven machines that this start-up uses. SaaS-based collaborative tools like Google Docs which is free helps the dispersed team to improve efficiency. Social media like Facebook, Twitter are used to save on the marketing dollars.

The team also built customised web applications, using open source tech-

nology to keep track of payments due to product partners and affiliates.

Where is this SoHo headed?

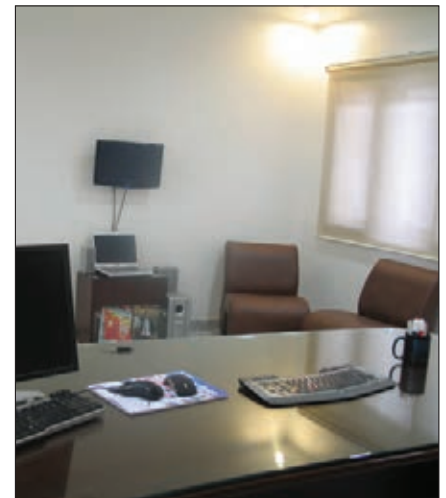
The partners, Sundeep and Abhishek, project a revenue of Rs. 20 Lakhs in the first year and Rs. 3 Crores by the end of the third year. Eleven months from now they expect to cross the 12-person mark thereby easing their way out of the SoHo category.

Digital Inspiration

Amit Agarwal runs one of India's top technology blogs from Agra. His aim is to demystify technology to make people's lives more efficient.

What's this SoHo about?

The blog was launched in 2004, and is now among the Top 100 Technology Blogs on the Internet. The site aims to get its users to make the most out of software tools and web technologies. Through his blog,



A blog can be a lucrative business, as Digital Inspiration has proven to be

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